We only cover a private room if we determine it to be medically necessary. Otherwise, we will pay the hospital's average charge for semi- private accommodations. The remaining balance is not a covered expense. If the hospital only has private rooms, we will cover the private room rate.

For out-of-network facilities on the Elevate Option, you are responsible for obtaining precertification for these services.

- **Warning**

In-network: Network Plan physicians must provide or arrange your in-network care and get precertification or preauthorization for certain services and/or procedures, including but not limited to those noted below in *Other services that require preauthorization*.

> **Note: Avoid paying providers for services prior to preauthorization. It is important to assure services are authorized and provided by a covered provider or facility.**

Out-of-network (Elevate only):

You must get precertification for certain services prior to admission. Failure to do so will result in the following penalties, unless due to a medical emergency:

- We will reduce our benefits for the Inpatient Hospital stay, Long Term Acute Care, Residential Treatment Center (RTC), Skilled Nursing Facility (SNF), or Rehabilitation Facility stay by **$500 per day for each day that is not precertified prior to admission, limited to a maximum penalty of $5,000 per admission**. If the stay is not medically necessary, we will only pay for any covered medical services and supplies that are otherwise payable on an outpatient basis.

- **Exceptions**

You do not need precertification in these cases:

- You have another group health insurance policy that is the primary payor for the facility stay or other services; or
- Medicare Part A is primary payor for the facility stay. If you exhaust your Medicare hospital benefits and do not want to use your Medicare lifetime reserve days, then we will become the primary payor, and you **do** need precertification.

Other services

Some surgeries and procedures, drugs, tests, services and equipment require precertification or preauthorization. Specific services requiring preauthorization or precertification are indicated in Section 5, when applicable. Please note this list is subject to change, please call to verify if your procedure requires preauthorization.

Services requiring preauthorization or medical necessity determination may be reviewed with guidelines as described at geha.com/Coverage-Criteria. G.E.H.A has coverage policies for many services and procedures; refer to geha.com/Provider-Policies for a complete list of policies.

Transplants services require more extensive reviews. The transplant must be performed in a designated transplant facility to receive maximum benefits.

If precertification is not obtained or a Plan-designated transplant facility is not used, our allowance will be limited for hospital and surgery expenses up to a maximum of $100,000 per transplant. If we cannot refer a member in need of a transplant to a designated facility, the $100,000 maximum will not apply.

- Tandem bone marrow transplants approved as one treatment protocol are limited to $100,000 when not performed at a Plan-designated facility. All treatment within 120 days following the transplant is subject to the $100,000 limit. Outpatient prescription drugs are not a part of the $100,000 limit.
- Simultaneous transplants such as kidney/pancreas, heart/lung, heart/liver are considered as one transplant procedure and are limited to $100,000 when not performed at a Plan-designated transplant facility.